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UAE Presidential Court

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets Kristalina Georgieva, Managing Director of the International Monetary Fund (IMF), at Qasr Al Shati.

Largest ever World Governments Summit opens in Dubai today

Event is set to draw over 6,250 participants, including 35 heads of state

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

The largest edition of the World Governments Summit opens in Dubai today, bringing together a record number of global leaders, policymakers and business executives.

Running from today to February 5, under the theme “Shaping Future Governments,” the summit is set to draw more than 6,250 participants, including 35 heads of state, representatives from 150 governments and around 500 ministers. Leaders attending the summit include the King of Bhutan, the presidents of Switzerland, Ecuador, Estonia and Kosovo, and senior

DEAR READERS

The delivery of your *Gulf News* may be slightly delayed for the next three days due to the World Governments Summit. We want to apologise for any inconvenience in advance. You can also get live coverage and the e-edition on gulfnews.com now.

Gulf figures such as the Crown Prince of Kuwait. Several heads of government will also be present, including the prime ministers of Spain, Albania, Egypt, the Kurdistan Region of Iraq and Dominica.

Series of forums

The opening day is set to host a series of forums, ministerial meetings and roundtables, bringing together heads of state and government, senior of-

ficials, leaders of international organisations, futurists, thought leaders and experts.

The agenda spans artificial intelligence, future travel, trade, logistics, tourism, education, health care, sustainable cities and investment. More than 300 sessions, 24 global forums and 35 high-level meetings are scheduled, with participation from organisations including the International Monetary Fund, World Bank and OECD.

Speaking at the Arab Fiscal Forum held on the sidelines of the summit, IMF managing director Kristalina Georgieva said the Arab region has sustained growth momentum despite global volatility. “It is impressive what the Arab region has achieved despite the tough times,” she said, pointing to reforms that have strengthened economic foundations amid shifting geopolitics, trade policy and technological change.

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UAE denies any administrative role in Gaza

GAZA’S RAFAH BORDER CROSSING WITH EGYPT REOPENS FOR LIMITED TRAFFIC

ABU DHABI/GAZA

Reem Al Hashimy, Minister of State for International Cooperation, has categorically denied the false and unfounded claim that the UAE will assume civilian administration of Gaza.

The UAE has repeatedly reaffirmed that Gaza’s governance and administration are the responsibility of the Palestinian people. Al Hashimy underscored that the UAE remains committed to scaling up its humanitarian efforts to support Palestinians in Gaza and advancing a durable peace between Israelis and Palestinians, including through its role as a Board of Peace founding member and its membership on the Gaza Executive Board.

Meanwhile, Gaza’s Rafah border crossing with Egypt reopened yesterday for limited traffic, a key step as the Israeli-Hamas truce moves ahead, according to Egyptian and Israeli security officials.

50 in each direction

An Egyptian official said 50 Palestinians would cross in each direction on the first day of the crossing’s operation. The official, involved in talks related to the implementation of the ceasefire deal, spoke to the Associated Press on condition of anonymity to discuss the issue.

State-run Egyptian media and an Israeli security official also confirmed the reopening, which

About 20,000 Palestinian children and adults needing medical care hope to leave devastated Gaza via the crossing, according to Gaza health officials.

for now at least, is largely symbolic. Few people will be allowed to travel in either direction, and no goods will be allowed to enter.

About 20,000 Palestinian children and adults needing medical care hope to leave devastated Gaza via the crossing, according to Gaza health officials.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has also said that Israel will allow 50 patients a day to leave. An official involved said each patient would be allowed to travel with two relatives, while some 50 people who left Gaza during the war would be allowed to return each day.

The Egyptian health ministry said in a statement yesterday that 150 hospitals across the country have been prepared to receive Palestinian patients and wounded who will be evacuated from Gaza through the Rafah crossing. Israel has said it and Egypt will vet people for exit and entry through the crossing, which will be supervised by European Union border patrol agents with a small Palestinian presence. — WAM, AP

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